

HR-205 Promotion and Career Progression

Policy ID: HR-205 Version: 3.2 Classification: Internal
Effective Date: 1 January 2026 Owner: People Operations
Applies to: All permanent employees

1 Purpose and Scope

This policy sets out how employees progress to a higher level, the eligibility requirements that must be met before a promotion can be considered, and the process by which promotion decisions are made and reviewed.

2 The Career Framework

Every role sits at a defined level in the career framework. Each level describes the scope, autonomy, and impact expected of an employee working at it. Promotion means an employee is already operating consistently at the next level, not that they are expected to grow into it.

The framework and the expectations for every level are published on the intranet and are reviewed annually by People Operations.

3 Promotion

3.1 Promotion Cycles

Promotions are considered twice a year, following each formal performance review. Nominations open in February and August and close four weeks later. Out-of-cycle promotions are permitted only where a role has materially changed, and require approval from the relevant director and People Operations.

3.2 Promotion Eligibility Requirements

To be eligible for promotion, an employee must meet all of the following requirements at the point of nomination.

- They have held their current role for at least twelve months of continuous service, and have completed any probationary period
- Their two most recent performance evaluations are rated at meets expectations or above, with at least one rated exceeds expectations or above
- They are not subject to an active performance improvement plan, and have no live formal disciplinary warning on record
- They have demonstrated the expectations of the next level in the career framework across at least two consecutive quarters, evidenced by delivered work
- Their manager supports the nomination, and a second manager at or above the target level endorses it

Meeting the eligibility requirements does not guarantee promotion. Eligibility determines whether a nomination can be considered; the decision itself rests with the promotion panel described in the next section. Length of service alone is never grounds for promotion.

An employee who is not eligible may ask their manager for a written development plan setting out what would need to change for eligibility to be met in a future cycle.

3.3 Nomination and Panel Review

A manager submits a written nomination setting out the evidence against each expectation of the target level. Nominations are reviewed by a promotion panel of at least three managers working at or above the target level, chaired by People Operations. The panel is quorate only where no panel member is the

nominating manager.

The panel records its decision and reasoning. An employee whose nomination is unsuccessful receives written feedback from their manager within ten working days, including the specific evidence the panel found insufficient.

3.4 Outcome and Pay

A promotion takes effect from the first day of the month following the panel decision. Salary is adjusted to at least the minimum of the new level's range, and the employee receives a written variation to their contract of employment.

4 Internal Transfers

A move to a different team at the same level is a transfer, not a promotion, and is handled through the internal vacancy process. Transfers do not reset the twelve-month requirement in section three, provided the level is unchanged.

5 Records

Nominations, panel decisions, and feedback are retained in the human resources system for six years.